In 2009, the Tata Tea Group ‘announced a strategic reorganization of its beverages business’ as an integral step necessary to becoming a world leader. The $1 billion tea group ‘integrated its tea, coffee and water brands and businesses around the world’ and brought them ‘under a single management structure’. It now dealt with an array of products spanning a dizzying geographical footprint from Africa to America. The old name could no longer reflect its new size and reach. Tata Tea was thus renamed TGBL on 2 July 2010, with three subsidiaries: Tata Tea, Tata Coffee and Tata Tea (US). The logical next step was to integrate and simplify the business structure and rebrand it to reflect the global status and presence it achieved.

The Tetley deal is significant for being the first in a series of global acquisitions that Ratan went on to make for the Tata Group. Buoyed by its success, he went on to acquire two huge companies, Corus and Jaguar Land Rover (JLR), that made the world sit up and take note of not only the Tata Group but also Ratan as a courageous visionary.